

DynoWeb Vocabulary & Messaging Guide

Status: Canonical copy asset. The words we use **everywhere** — ads, website, App Store listing, emails, onboarding, sales scripts. If a line of merchant-facing copy contradicts this guide, the copy is wrong. Pairs with [dynoweb-icp.md](#) (who) and [competitor-wounds.md](#) (what rivals do badly + our counter) — this doc is *how we talk to them*.

Established: 2026-07-17 · **Method:** three primary-source research passes — real Shopify Community threads, r/shopify, App Store listings + 1–3★ reviews, competitor copy. Every USE/AVOID call traces to a quote or a listing, not a hunch. Blogspam rejected. Unsourced claims are marked **[INFERRED]**.

Change log: 2026-07-17 added §2.5 (trust/billing pillar) + wound-backed headlines in §5, from the competitor-wounds review mining.

0 · The one rule that governs everything

Merchants describe every feature in **OUTCOME language**, never **CAPABILITY language**. They don't want "a heatmap" — they want to know "why is nobody buying." Sell the sale you'll save, not the tool that saves it.

The winning pattern across every top competitor listing: **problem** → **what you'll see** → **the sale you'll save**. MIDA's headline is the template: *"See What's Costing You Sales — Then Fix It."*

Three hard bans, verified — these words are vendor-speak merchants never use:

Banned word	Say instead	Why
"CRO"	"why visitors don't buy", "lost sales"	Every CRO-titled Shopify Community thread was posted by <i>vendors talking to each other</i> . Merchants never say it.
"leaking funnel"	"traffic but no sales", "where you're losing sales"	Zero merchant posts found using it. Only vendor marketing.
"nudge"	"popup", "exit offer", "cart saver"	No top popup app leads with "nudge." Merchants search "popup." (SmartNudge stays the <i>product</i> name; ads/listing say popup — see §4.)
"attribution"	"what's making you money", "what's actually working"	Zero merchant-initiated use found. It's an ads-industry term. (see §9)

1 · The golden words — the master list

These are verified merchant words. Reach for these first, always.

Nouns / phrases (USE): lost sales · traffic but no sales · abandoned cart · popup · exit popup · show up on Google / get found · where my sales come from · what's making me money · drop off · stuck · friction · conversion rate · add to cart but don't buy

Verbs (USE) — the four merchants actually use:

see · watch · spot · find

Merchants want to *see* the problem. Every feature headline should let them picture themselves seeing/watching/spotting/finding something.

The money words (USE): makes money · earned you \$X · save the sale · worth it · stop wasting [ad spend]. Per repo convention (CLAUDE.md): in copy say **"sales"** and **"makes money"** — reserve "revenue" for forecast/leak language only.

Global AVOID list (analyst/agency/vendor-speak): CRO · leaking funnel · nudge · attribution · optimization platform · AI CRO Expert · incrementality · qualitative analytics · engagement zones · micro-conversion · behavioral intervention · SERP / meta / schema (as sell-words) · autopilot · set and forget

2 · Who we're talking to — the emotional state (this sets ad TONE)

The merchant looking for this is **not** an optimizer having fun. They are **frustrated, financially anxious, self-doubting, and close to quitting**. Verbatim, from real threads:

"It was so frustrating that I nearly wanted to quit... it can really shake your confidence." "Honestly I'm so fed up and put myself in so much debt." "What am I doing wrong?" "I could not figure out where that came from. Now I know."

Four tone rules that follow directly:

- 1 Lead with the feeling, not the feature.** "Traffic but no sales — and you don't know why" mirrors their exact internal monologue. Open there, not with "AI-powered analytics."
- 2 Reduce self-blame, restore agency.** They ask "what am I doing wrong." Copy that says *"it's not you — it's one fixable thing, and here's exactly which one"* converts anxiety into a next step.
- 3 Money is the emotional core, not just positioning.** They're in debt, they wasted ad spend. "Save the sale / show the money" speaks to real fear. Never bury the dollar tie.
- 4 Do not add to the overwhelm.** They're already buried in conflicting advice. Promise **one clear thing to fix first** — never "a dashboard of 40 metrics." (This is philosophy.md P1 + P6 in copy form.)

2.5 · Trust & billing — the category's open wound, so make it a pillar

From [competitor-wounds.md](#): **billing-trust is the #1 killer of every paid competitor — not features.** Lucky Orange hit a 7-year customer with a *"2,400% hike without explicit consent"*; OptiMonk pocketed a surprise \$800 annual. MIDA's calm billing is *why* it's the loved one. This is the **highest-leverage promise in the category**, so it earns its own messaging pillar — say it loud, everywhere.

USE (trust language — verified against rival scar tissue): - honest billing · no surprise charges, ever · bots don't burn your quota · a real human answers · your data stays yours · won't slow your store — we'll prove it · keep your history (Clarity forgets after 30 days; we don't)

The other verified wound = the act-gap. A real merchant on Lucky Orange: *"I like watching customers, but where is the value beyond that?"* Merchants can *watch* (free tools do it fine) but are stranded at "now what?" So **"we fix it, not just show it"** is a **core line**, not a feature bullet.

AVOID (their hate-words — quietly exorcise these feelings from our copy): money hungry · took thousands of dollars · use at your own risk · misleading · too many bugs · infuriating · if I can't use it, it's useless · slowed my whole store.

3 · Product names vs marketing names

Our internal product names are often vendor-speak. **Keep them in the UI/codebase; translate them in outward copy.**

Internal / product name	What ads, listing & website say
SmartNudge	"popups", "exit offers", "cart savers" — <i>never</i> lead with "nudge"
DynoAgent	"AI assistant" — framed as <i>drafts & proposes, you approve</i> (see §5)
CRO Report	"free store checkup", "your revenue-leak report", "what's costing you sales"
PECTI score / LIFT model	never surface these to merchants — pure internal jargon
Attribution (Conversions page)	"what's making you money", "what's actually working"
Impact	"the money DynoWeb made you"

4 · Per-feature vocabulary + ready-to-use copy

Each block: **USE** (merchant words) · **AVOID** · **Ready copy** (paste-able) · competitor proof.

Heatmaps (click / scroll / frustration maps)

- **USE:** "see where visitors click", "how far they scroll", "which buttons get ignored", "clicking something that isn't a link", "tapping a product image that doesn't zoom".
- **AVOID:** bare "rage click" / "dead click" without a plain-English translation; "attention mapping", "engagement zones", "viewport analysis".
- **Ready copy:** *"See exactly where shoppers click, scroll, and give up — on a picture of your own store." / "Is your Add to Cart button getting clicks, or getting ignored?"*
- **Rule:** Clarity introduced "rage click" and has to define it. If you use it, define it in the same breath: *"rage clicks — when a frustrated shopper taps the same thing over and over."*

Session Replay / recordings

- **USE:** the verb is **"watch."** "Watch what real shoppers did", "see where they drop off", "replay real shopper journeys".
- **AVOID:** "session reconstruction", "user journey analytics", "DOM playback".
- **Ready copy:** *"Watch a real shopper hit your store, hesitate, and leave — then see the exact moment you lost them."*
- **Proof:** Propel — *"recover lost sales with session recording"*; MIDA — *"Watch sessions & checkout to spot where users drop off."*

Popups / behavioral interventions (SmartNudge)

- **USE:** **"popup"** (the universal word), "exit popup", "exit-intent", "cart recovery", "free shipping bar", "announcement bar", "catch them before they leave", "save the sale".
- **AVOID:** **"nudge"** (vendor-only), "behavioral intervention", "micro-conversion trigger", "on-site engagement layer".
- **Ready copy:** *"Catch shoppers the moment they're about to leave — with the right offer, at the right second." / "A popup that fires when someone rage-clicks your size selector beats one that fires on a dumb 5-second timer."*
- **Watch out:** merchants are cynical about bad popups (*"fire immediately, cover the whole mobile screen, ask for emails before I've seen anything"*). **Promise the smart, well-timed version** — that's our honest edge.

- **Proof:** Wisepops — *"Cart Recovery... Designed to convert"*; OptiMonk files exit popups under an *"Abandoned cart"* bucket.

Cart abandonment

- **USE:** **"abandoned cart"** (dominant term, more searched than "cart abandonment"). Verb is **"recover"** — "recover abandoned carts", "recover lost sales". Plain speech: "they add to cart but don't buy".
- **AVOID:** "cart abandonment" *as a headline* (analyst inversion), "basket abandonment" (UK vendor term), "checkout funnel leakage".
- **Distinction to get right:** *abandoned cart* = added, left before checkout; *abandoned checkout* = entered checkout, didn't finish. Merchants and Shopify separate these.
- **Ready copy:** *"7 out of 10 shoppers fill a cart and leave. See why — and win them back."*

AI assistant / chat (DynoAgent) — handle with care

- **THE FINDING:** merchants distrust **"AI that manages your store."** They accept **"AI that helps, and you stay in control."** The distrust is loud and specific — Shopify's own AI push left merchants *"angry and confused"*; a merchant reported AI that *"hallucinates and invents new codes... has corrupted the organizational structure."*
- **USE:** "helps you", "does the busywork", **"you approve before anything goes live"**, "shows you its edits", "you stay in control", "drafts it, you decide".
- **AVOID (each one reads as the thing they just got burned by):** "AI manages your store", "autopilot", "set it and forget it", "the AI runs your store", "fully automated", "AI store manager".
- **Ready copy:** *"An AI assistant that drafts the fix and shows you exactly what it'll change — nothing goes live until you say yes."*
- **Why this works for us:** it maps to DynoAgent's *real* approve-before-apply flow (AgentAction). Lead with the control, and the honesty becomes the selling point.

AI product descriptions / copywriting

- **USE:** "write your product descriptions", "saves you hours", "in your brand voice", "sounds like you, not a robot".
- **AVOID:** "content engine", "bulk-spun descriptions", "NLG". ("Bulk" as a feature is fine — "write all your descriptions at once" — but always pair with the brand-voice reassurance.)
- **The fear to preempt:** the word is **"generic."** Merchants fear AI copy sounds generic. Promise *"in your brand voice, not generic filler — and you edit before it publishes."*

SEO (get found on Google)

- **USE:** "show up on Google", "get found on Google", "rank on Google", "more organic traffic", "appear when people search for what you sell".
- **AVOID as sell-words:** "meta description", "schema / structured data", "title tags", "SERP", "technical SEO audit", "alt text". These are the *fixes you perform*, not the *words you sell with*. Shopify itself has to define "meta description" every time — the tell that it's not merchant vocabulary.
- **Ready copy:** *"Show up on Google when people search for what you sell — we fix the behind-the-scenes stuff for you automatically."* (mechanism as reassurance, outcome as the sell)
- **[INFERRED]** that merchants specifically find *schema* confusing — strongly implied by the volume of explainer content, but not captured from a verbatim merchant post.

Revenue / "show the money" (Impact + Conversions)

- **USE:** "what's actually working", "what's making me money", "which button makes you money", "is it worth it", "the money DynoWeb made you". Concrete money framing wins.

- **AVOID: "attribution"** (industry term, merchants never say it), "incrementality", "multi-touch attribution", "revenue attribution engine". Even bare "revenue" is slightly vendor-tilted — prefer "sales" / "makes money".
- **Ready copy:** *"See which button, image, and page actually make you money — and which are dead weight."*
- **Note:** DynoWeb's *"this earned you \$X"* framing is already exactly right. Keep it. Never label the UI or an ad "Attribution."
- **Proof:** MIDA — *"See which elements make money & which waste space"*; OptiMonk — *"Optimize for real revenue, not just clicks."*

Traffic sources / which ads work

- **USE:** "which ads actually work", "where my sales come from", "stop wasting ad spend", "where your buyers come from".
- **AVOID:** "channel attribution", "UTM analytics", "traffic-source segmentation", "conversion path analysis".
- **Ready copy:** *"Facebook sends 500 visitors and \$0. Email sends 50 and \$1,200. Know which ads actually make sales — and stop paying for the ones that don't."*
- **[INFERRED]** the exact "which ads work" phrasing is synthesized from agency/Shopify sources, not a captured verbatim community quote — solid, but worth one community pull before locking a headline solely on it.

The overall AI-diagnosis pitch

- **THE PATTERN THAT WINS:** *"tells you what to fix first"* (diagnosis = welcome, they're overwhelmed) + *"you approve, then we fix it"* (action = merchant-gated).
- Merchants explicitly want to be told where to look — but not to have the AI act unilaterally. Competitors who say the AI *tells/analyzes* are trusted; the ones who say the AI *does* draw the distrust.
- **Our differentiator** — that we can actually deploy the fix (popups, SEO autofix) — must be framed as **"and when you're ready, we deploy it for you,"** never "the AI runs it."
- **AVOID:** "AI decides", "auto-fixes everything", "hands-off optimization", "the AI takes it from here".

5 • The headline formula

From the ICP + emotional state + outcome rule, the master template:

[merchant's feeling / problem in their words] → [what they'll see] → [the sale they'll save].

Worked examples (paste-able): - *"Traffic but no sales? See exactly why shoppers leave — and win them back."* - *"You're not doing it wrong. One fixable thing is costing you sales. Here's which one."* - *"Watch real shoppers hit your store and leave — then fix the reason in one click."* - *"Free store checkup: see what's costing you sales this month, in plain English."*

Wound-backed headlines (each aimed at a documented rival weakness — see competitor-wounds.md): - *"Stop watching them leave. Start fixing why."* ← the act-gap ("value beyond just watching?") - *"Honest billing. No surprise charges. Ever."* ← Lucky Orange / OptiMonk billing rage - *"A real human answers."* ← Clarity's support black hole - *"Your data stays yours — not fed to an ad giant."* ← Microsoft-privacy fear - *"Under 5KB. Won't touch your store speed — and we'll prove it."* ← Hotjar/Lucky Orange bloat - *"Popups that fire when they're actually leaving — not two seconds after they arrive."* ← OptiMonk timing

The App Store hero line should be one of these, **not** "AI-powered CRO platform for Shopify."

6 • Cheat sheet — pin this above the keyboard

Feature	USE (merchant words)	NEVER say
Overall pitch	"why visitors don't buy", "lost sales", "traffic but no sales"	"CRO", "leaking funnel", "AI CRO Expert"
Heatmaps	"see where they click / scroll", "buttons being ignored"	bare "rage/dead click", "engagement zones"
Session replay	"watch what shoppers did", "see where they drop off"	"session reconstruction", "qualitative analytics"
Popups (SmartNudge)	"popup", "exit popup", "cart recovery", "catch them before they leave"	" nudge ", "behavioral intervention"
Cart	"abandoned cart", "recover carts", "add to cart but don't buy"	"cart abandonment" (headline), "basket abandonment"
AI assistant (DynoAgent)	"helps you", "you approve before it goes live", "shows its work"	"AI manages your store", "autopilot", "set & forget"
AI copywriting	"write descriptions", "saves time", "in your brand voice"	"content engine", "bulk-spun", "generic" (unless denying it)
SEO	"show up on Google", "get found", "rank", "organic traffic"	"meta/schema/SERP", "technical SEO audit"
Money	"what's making money", "what's working", "worth it", "earned you \$X"	" attribution ", "incrementality", "revenue engine"
Traffic sources	"which ads work", "where sales come from", "stop wasting ad spend"	"channel attribution", "UTM analytics"
AI diagnosis	"tells you what to fix first" + "you decide / you approve"	"AI decides", "auto-fixes everything"
Trust / billing (\$2.5)	"honest billing", "no surprise charges", "bots don't burn your quota", "a human answers"	(echo none of the rival hate-words)

7 · How to use this

- **Writing any ad, page, listing, or email?** Draft it, then run it against §6. If it contains a NEVER word, rewrite — regardless of how good it sounds.
- **Naming a feature externally?** Check §3 — use the marketing name, not the product name.
- **Setting the tone?** Re-read §2. The reader is anxious and near-quitting, not curious.
- **When this doc is wrong, update it with evidence + date.** Living doc; changes by data, never by vibe. Two items are flagged [**INFERRED**] (SEO-schema confusion, the verbatim "which ads work" phrasing) — close them with one more community pull before locking headline copy that rests solely on them.

Sources

Primary sources only; blogspam rejected. Full quotes and URLs live in the two research passes that produced this (session 2026-07-17). Anchors:

- **Merchant vocabulary & emotion:** Shopify Community threads ("heavy traffic but no sales", "help no sales getting frustrated", "how do I get found on Google", "augmentation instead of automation", the Sidekick/Magic AI-distrust thread)
- **Competitor listing copy:** App Store listings for Microsoft Clarity, MIDA, Propel, Lucky Orange, Wisepops, OptiMonk
- **Reviews:** Clarity, MIDA, Propel, "Product Description AI" App Store reviews
- **Internal:** [dynoweb-icp.md](#) §6, [philosophy.md](#) (P1 act-don't-mirror, P6 plain-language, P8 honesty), [docs/DYNOWEB_FEATURES.md](#) (feature inventory), [CLAUDE.md](#) (sales-vs-revenue convention)